NIH NATIONAL CANCER INSTITUTE

Personal Stories About Participating in Cancer Research

Read personal stories from patients and physicians about their clinical trial experience.



Today's Clinical Trials are Tomorrow's Standard of Care

Keenly aware of how breast cancer affects her community, Adine's first step was to find an oncologist she could trust before joining a clinical trial.



Enrolling in a Clinical Trial in Rural America

Read about how the NCI Community Oncology Research Program (NCORP) helps cancer patients like Kellie get care from clinical trials in their local communities.



Once Terminal, Now Controllable Chronic Myeloid Leukemia

Diagnosed with chronic myeloid leukemia, Mel was running out of time when he enrolled in a clinical trial.



Reaching the Stars with a New Immunotherapy Drug



Allen participated in an NCI clinical trial testing a combination therapy after running out of standard treatment options for his non-Hodgkin lymphoma. Read about his story.



Combining Drugs to Treat Ovarian Cancer

Approximately 70% of women diagnosed with ovarian cancer will die from the disease. Read about the NCI-funded combination drug trial that has successfully treated Betsy's recurrent cancer.



Treating Prostate Cancer Closer to Home

Jerome’s prostate cancer was successfully treated at a cancer center close to his home. Read about how NCI’s community oncology research program NCORP is helping cancer patients in their local communities.



Inherited Risk for Prostate Cancer Spurs Research Participation

Joe's family history of cancer and a BRCA2 mutation led him to join a clinical trial that caught his prostate cancer early.



Hitting a Home Run with an Investigational Drug

NCI and the Children’s Oncology Group conducted a clinical trial testing crizotinib (Xalkori), a drug that targets mutations in a gene called ALK. Read about Zach, a patient with anaplastic large cell lymphoma, who took part in

the trial.



Breaking Old Habits and Expanding Access to Clinical Trials

Clinical trials help broaden access to cancer care, offering patients options like immunotherapy that did not exist 50 years ago.



Opting for a Novel Combination Treatment for Resistant Aggressive B-Cell Lymphoma

NCI is testing a novel five-drug therapy called ViPOR for non-Hodgkin lymphoma. Enrolling in the trial changed Justin's life.



Shrinking a Tumor, Changing a Life

NCI scientists first identified TRK fusions, which led to the development of larotrectinib, a therapy that shrunk baby Rihanna's tumor. Read about Rihanna's story.



Finding a Voice and Surviving Breast Cancer

When met with silence from women in the Navajo Nation, the support of family kept Vivian going during her breast cancer clinical trial.



Changing the Life of a Patient with von Hippel-Lindau